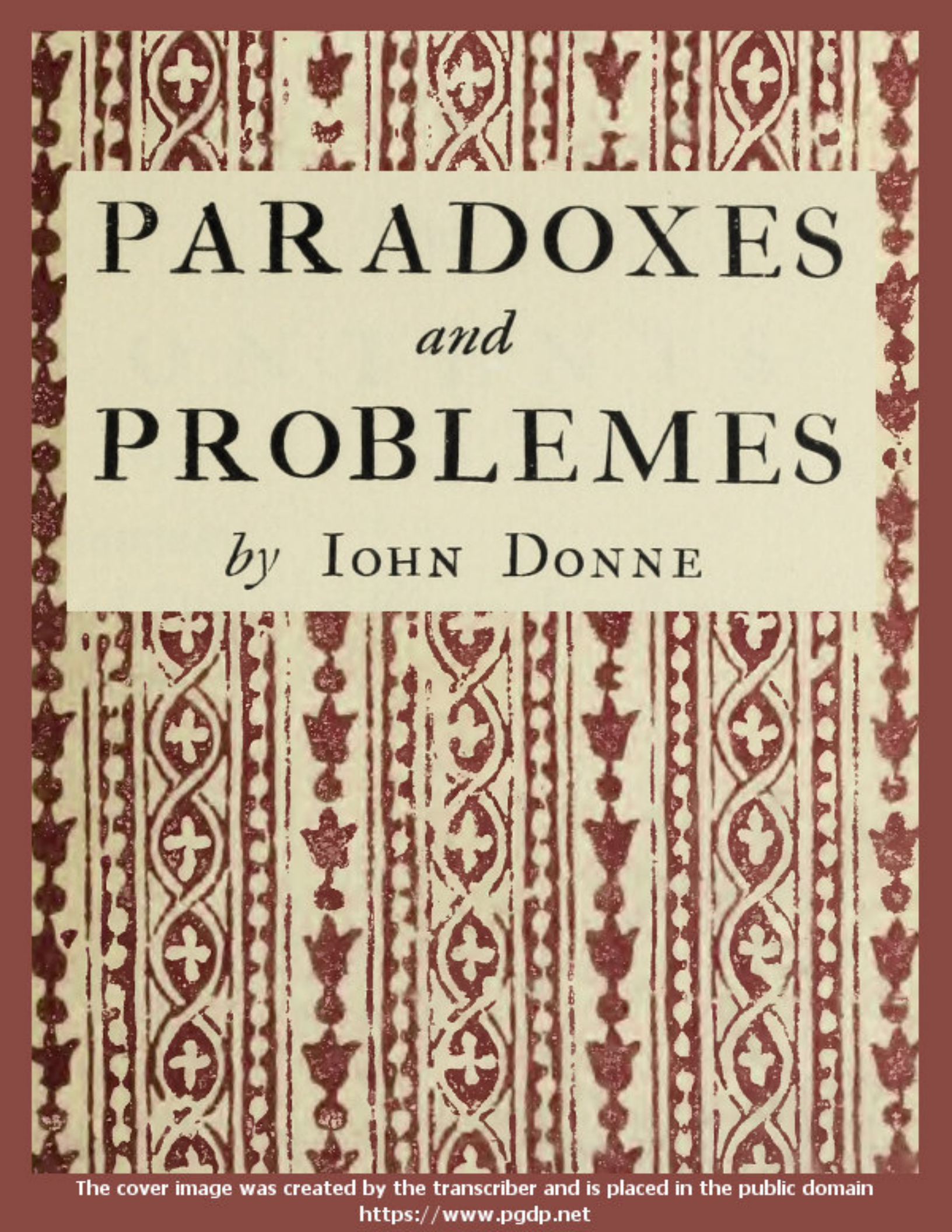




PARADOXES

and

PROBLEMES

by IOHN DONNE

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PARADOXES AND PROBLEMES ***



PARADOXES *and* PROBLEMES

by IOHN DONNE
with two Characters
and an Essay of
VALOUR



*Now for the first time reprinted from the editions
of 1633 and 1652 with one additional PROBLEME*

SOHO
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This edition is limited to 645 copies, printed and made in England for the Nonesuch Press in the 17th century Fell types by Frederick Hall, printer to the University of Oxford. The type has been distributed. This is number 9



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BIBLIOGRAPHICAL NOTE

Donne's Paradoxes and Problemes are clever and entertaining trifles, which were probably written before 1600, during the more wanton period of their author's life. Owing to their scurrilous nature they could not be published during his lifetime, but shortly after his death the greater part of them were licensed to be printed, the Imprimatur printed at the end both of the eleven Paradoxes and of the ten Problemes being signed by Sir Henry Herbert and dated October 25, 1632. The volume was published under the title of *Juvenilia* in 1633, but already on November 14, 1632, an order of inquiry had been delivered at the King's command by the Bishop of London, calling upon Sir Henry Herbert to explain before the Board of the Star Chamber his reasons 'why hee warrented the booke of D. Duns paradoxes to be printed'. Perhaps Herbert's explanations were regarded as satisfactory, but, however this may have been, the King was not successful in suppressing the book. The volume is a thin quarto containing only thirty-two leaves, and was printed by Elizabeth Purslowe for Henry Seyle, to be sold at the sign of the Tyger's Head in St. Paul's Church-yard. The printer seems to have been somewhat careless in imposing the licences, for, although most copies contain the two, copies occur from which one or both have been omitted. It is not known through what channels the publisher obtained possession of the text, but it is probable that the publication was quite unauthorized, and took place even without the

knowledge of the younger Donne, who, when he reprinted the *Juvenilia* in 1652, made no reference to any previous issue.

The *Juvenilia* were at once in considerable demand, and seem to have been bought by many of the purchasers of the *Poems*, which were also first published in quarto in 1633. This is evident from the fact that the two books are so often found together in contemporary bindings, the lesser volume usually being relegated to the end. The first edition of the *Juvenilia* was thus soon exhausted and a second edition was published in the same year. So ineffectual did the Star Chamber inquiry prove to have been that in this edition the publisher not only omitted the *Imprimatus* altogether and so abandoned all pretence of having any official sanction for the publication, but even added to the first *Probleme*, 'Why have Bastards best Fortune?', which was particularly offensive to the Court, twenty-three lines which had not appeared in the first edition. This edition, as before a quarto and with the same imprint, but containing only twenty-four leaves, is considerably rarer than its predecessor. It is unlikely, however, that this fact is to be attributed to the King's having had any greater success than before in suppressing it. More probably the demand for it was less, so that part of the edition remained unsold and was subsequently destroyed.

In 1652 the younger Donne, in the course of his exploitation of his father's writings, prepared an authorized edition of the *Juvenilia*, which was printed by Thomas Newcomb for Humphrey Moseley. The number of the *Paradoxes* was now increased to twelve and of the *Problemes* to seventeen, the offensive passages in the first *Probleme* being allowed to remain. To these were added two 'Characters', 'An Essay of Valour', 'A Sheaf of Miscellany Epigrams', a reprint of Ignatius his *Conclave*, and, finally, the *Essays in Divinity*. The *Epigrams* purport to have been written by the elder Donne in Latin and to have been translated into English by Jasper Mayne, D.D. They may have been printed by the younger Donne in good faith, as it seems to be certain that his father's *Epigrammata*

mea Latina once existed; but the epigrams attributed to him in this volume are, as Mr. Gosse has shown (Life and Letters of Donne, i. 16), certainly spurious, and may well have been composed, as well as translated, by Mayne, who was an unprincipled, though witty, divine. The Essays in Divinity had been printed in 1651 for a different publisher, but they are very rarely found as a separate volume in a contemporary binding, for the younger Donne, as he made clear in his preface, sought to temper the secularity of the Juvenilia by issuing them in company with the Essays in Divinity, and in this way to invest the volume with an altogether fictitious respectability.

Even in 1652 the Paradoxes and Problemes were not printed entire. Another Probleme concerning Sir Walter Raleigh has been preserved in the Bodleian Library (Tanner MSS. 299, f. 32), the copier stating that it 'was so bitter that his son, Jack Donne, LL.D., thought fit not to print it with the rest'. Yet another has recently been discovered in a manuscript containing Donne's poems.

The Juvenilia have not been reprinted since 1652. In the present edition the text follows that of the second edition of 1633, amplified from the third edition of 1652 and with the additional Probleme from the Bodleian manuscript, already printed by Mr. Edmund Gosse in his Life and Letters of Donne, 1899, ii. 52. The spurious epigrams have not been included.

GEOFFREY KEYNES



PARADOXES

1.

A Defence of Womens Inconstancy.



That Women are *Inconstant*, I with any man
 confesse, but that *Inconstancy* is a bad quality,
 I against any man will maintaine: For every
 thing as it is one better than another, so is it
 fuller of *change*; The *Heavens* themselves
 continually turne, the *Starres* move, the *Moone*
 changeth; *Fire* whirlleth, *Ayre* flyeth, *Water*
 ebbs and flowes, the face of the *Earth* altereth her lookes, *time*
 stayes not; the Colour that is most light, will take most dyes: so
 in Men, they that have the most reason are the most alterable
 in their designes, and the darkest or most ignorant, do seldomest
 change; therefore Women changing more than Men, have also
 more *Reason*. They cannot be immutable like stockes, like
 stones, like the Earths dull Center; Gold that lyeth still, rusteth;
 Water, corrupteth; Aire that moveth not, poysoneth; then why
 should that which is the perfection of other things, be imputed
 to Women as greatest imperfection? Because thereby they
 deceive men. Are not your wits pleased with those jests, which
 coozen your expectation? You can call it Pleasure to be

beguil'd in troubles, and in the most excellent toy in the world, you call it Treachery: I would you had your *Mistresses* so constant, that they would never change, no not so much as their *smocks*, then should you see what fluttish vertue, *Constancy* were. *Inconstancy* is a most commendable and cleanly quality, and Women in this quality are farre more absolute than the Heavens, than the Starres, Moone, or any thing beneath it; for long obfervation hath pickt certainty out of their mutability. The Learned are so well acquainted with the Starres, Signes and Planets, that they make them but Characters, to reade the meaning of the Heaven in his owne forehead. Every simple Fellow can bespeake the change of the *Moone* a great while beforehand: but I would faine have the learnedst man so skilfull, as to tell when the simplest Woman meaneth to varie. Learning affords no rules to know, much lesse knowledge to rule the minde of a Woman: For as *Philosophy* teacheth us, that *Light things doe alwayes tend upwards*, and *heavy things decline downward*; Experience teacheth us otherwise, that the disposition of a *Light* Woman, is to fall downe, the nature of Women being contrary to all Art and Nature. Women are like *Flies*, which feed among us at our Table, or *Fleas* sucking our very blood, who leave not our most retired places free from their familiarity, yet for all their fellowship will they never bee tamed nor commanded by us. Women are like the *Sunne*, which is violently carried one way, yet hath a proper course contrary: so though they, by the mastery of some over-ruling churlish Husbands, are forced to his Byas, yet have they a motion of their owne, which their Husbands never know of. It is the nature of nice and fastidious mindes to know things onely to bee weary of them: Women by their flye *changeablenesse*, and pleasing doubleness, prevent even the mislike of those, for they can never be so well knowne, but that there is still more unknowne. Every Woman is a *Science*; for hee that plods upon a Woman all his life long, shall at length find himselfe short of the knowledge of her: they are borne to take downe the pride of wit, and ambition of wisedome, making *fooles* wise in the adventuring to winne them, *wifemen* fooles in conceit of losing

their labours; witty men starke mad, being confounded with their uncertainities. *Philosophers* write against them for spight, not desert, that having attained to some knowledge in all other things, in them onely they know nothing, but are meere ignorant: *Active* and *Experienced* men raile against them, because they love in their livelesse and decrepit age, when all goodnesse leaves them. These envious *Libellers* ballad against them, because having nothing in themselves able to deserve their love, they maliciously discommend all they cannot obtaine, thinking to make men beleieve they know much, because they are able to dispraise much, and rage against *Inconstancy*, when they were never admitted into so much favour as to be forsaken. In mine Opinion such men are happy that Women are *Inconstant*, for so may they chance to bee beloved of some excellent Women (when it comes to their turne) out of their *Inconstancy* and mutability, though not out of their owne desert. And what reason is there to clog any Woman with one Man, bee hee never so singular? Women had rather, and it is farre better and more Iudiciall to enjoy all the vertues in severall Men, than but some of them in one, for otherwise they lose their taste, like divers sorts of meat minced together in one dish: and to have all excellencies in one Man (if it were possible) is *Confusion* and *Diversity*. Now who can deny, but such as are obstinately bent to undervalue their worth, are those that have not soule enough to comprehend their excellency, Women being the most excellentest Creatures, in that Man is able to subject all things else, and to grow wise in every thing, but still persists a foole in Woman? The greatest *Scholler*, if hee once take a Wife, is found so unlearned, that he must begin his *Horne-booke*, and all is by *Inconstancy*. To conclude therefore; this name of *Inconstancy*, which hath so much beene poysoned with flanders, ought to bee changed into *variety*, for the which the world is so delightfull, and a Woman for that the most delightfull thing in this world.



2.

That Women ought to paint.

Lowliness is *Lothsome*: can that be so which helps it? who forbids his Beloved to gird in her waste? to mend by shooing her uneven lameness? to burnish her teeth? or to perfume her breath? yet that the *Face* bee more precisely regarded, it concernes more: For as open confessing finners are alwaies punished, but the wary and concealing offenders without witness doe it also without punishment; so the secret parts needs the lesse respect; but of the *Face*, discovered to all Examinations and surveys, there is not too nice a Iealousie. Nor doth it onely draw the busie eyes, but it is subject to the divinest touch of all, to *kissing*, the strange and mysticall union of soules. If shee should prostitute her selfe to a more unworthy Man than thy selfe, how earnestly and justly wouldst thou exclaime? that for want of this easier and ready way of repairing, to betray her body to ruine and deformity (the tyrannous *Ravishers*, and sodaine *Deflourers* of all Women) what a heynous Adultery is it? What thou lovest in her *face* is *colour*, and *painting* gives that, but thou hatest it, not because it is, but because thou knowest it. Foole, whom ignorance makes happy; the Starres, the Sunne, the Skye whom thou admirest, alas, have no *colour*, but are faire, because they seeme to bee coloured: If this seeming will not satisfie thee in her, thou hast good assurance of

her *colour*, when thou see'st her *lay* it on. If her *face* bee *painted* on a Boord or Wall, thou wilt love it, and the Boord, and the Wall: Canst thou loath it then when it speaks, smiles, and kisses, because it is *painted*? Are wee not more delighted with seeing Birds, Fruites, and Beasts *painted* then wee are with Naturalls? And doe wee not with pleasure behold the *painted* shape of Monsters and Divels, whom true, wee durst not regard? Wee repaire the ruines of our houses, but first cold tempests warnes us of it, and bytes us through it; wee mend the wracke and stains of our Apparell, but first our eyes, and other bodies are offended; but by this providence of Women, this is ⁸prevented. If in *kissing* or *breathing* upon her, the *painting* fall off, thou art angry, wilt thou be so, if it sticke on? Thou didst love her, if thou beginnest to hate her, then 'tis because shee is not *painted*. If thou wilt say now, thou didst hate her before, thou didst hate her and love her together, bee constant in something, and love her who shewes her great *love* to thee, in taking this paines to seeme *lovely* to thee.



3.

That by Discord things increafe.

*Nullos esse Deos, inane Cælum
Affirmat Cælius, probatq; quod se
Factum vidit, dum negat hæc, beatum.*



So I assevere this the more boldly, because while I maintaine it, and feele the *Contrary repugnancies* and *adverse fightings* of the *Elements* in my Body, my Body increaseth; and whilst I differ from common opinions by this *Discord*, the number of my *Paradoxes* increaseth. All the rich benefits we can frame to our selves in *Concord*, is but an *Even* conservation of things; in which *Evennesse* wee can expect no *change*, no *motion*; therefore no *increafe* or *augmentation*, which is a *member of motion*. And if this *unity* and *peace* can give *increafe* to things, ¹⁸how mightily is *discord* and *war* to that purpose, which are indeed the onely ordinary *Parents* of *peace*. *Discord* is never so barren that it affords no fruit; for the *fall* of one *estate* is at the worst the *increaser* of another, because it is as impossible to finde a *discommodity* without *advantage*, as to finde *Corruption* without *Generation*: But it is the *Nature* and *Office* of *Concord*

to *preserve* onely, which property when it leaves, it differs from it selfe, which is the greatest *discord* of all. All *Victories* and *Emperies* gained by *warre*, and all *Iudiciall* decidings of doubts in *peace*, I doe claime children of *Discord*. And who can deny but *Controversies* in *Religion* are growne greater by *discord*, and not the *Controversie*, but *Religion* it selfe: For in a *troubled misery* Men are alwaies more *Religious* then in a *secure peace*. The number of *good* men, the onely charitable nourishers of *Concord*, wee see is thinne, and daily melts and waines; but of *bad discording* it is infinite, and growes houely. Wee are ascertained of all *Disputable* doubts, onely by *arguing* and differing in *Opinion*, and if formall *disputation* (which is but a painted, counterfeit, and dissembled *discord*) can worke us this benefit, what shall not a full and maine *discord* accomplish? Truly me thinkes I owe a *devotion*, yea a *sacrifice* to *discord*, for casting that *Ball* upon *Ida*, and for all that businesse of *Troy*, whom ruin'd I admire more then *Babylon*, *Rome*, or *Quinzay*, removed *Corners*, not onely fulfilled with her *fame*, but with *Cities* and *Thrones* planted by her *Fugitives*. Lastly, between *Cowardice* and *despaire*, *Valour* is gendred; and so the *Discord* of *Extreames* begets all vertues, but of the *like things* there is no issue without a miracle:

Vxor pessima, pessimus maritus
Mirror tam malè convenire.

Hee wonders that betweene two so *like*, there could be any *discord*, yet perchance for all this *discord* there was nere the lesse *increase*.



4.

That good is more common then evill.



have not been so pittifully tired with any *vanity*, as with filly *Old Mens* exclaiming against these times, and extolling their owne: Alas! they betray themselves, for if the *times* be *changed*, their manners have changed them. But their senses are to *pleasures*, as *sick Mens* tastes are to *Liquors*; for indeed no *new thing* is done in the *world*, all things are what, and as they were, and *Good* is as ever it was, more plenteous, and must of necessity be *more common then evill*, because it hath this for *nature* and *perfection* to bee *common*. It makes *Love* to all *Natures*, all, all affect it. So that in the *Worlds* early *Infancy*, there was a time when nothing was *evill*, but if this *World* shall suffer *dotage* in the extreamest *crookednesse* thereof, there shall be no time when nothing shall be *good*. It dares appeare and spread, and glister in the *World*, but *evill* buries it selfe in night and darknesse, and is chastised and suppressed when *good* is cherished and rewarded. And as *Imbroderers*, *Lapidaries*, and other *Artisans*, can by all things adorne their workes; for by adding better things, the better they shew in *Lush* and in *Eminency*; so *good* doth not onely prostrate her *amiablenessse* to all, but refuses no end, no not of her utter contrary *evill*, that shee may bee the more *common* to us. For *euill manners* are *parents* of *good Lawes*; and in every *evill* there is an

excellency, which (in common speech) we call *good*. For the fashions of *habits*, for our moving in *gestures*, for phrales in our *speech*, we say they were *good* as long as they were used, that is, as long as they were *common*; and wee eate, wee walke, onely when it is, or seemes *good* to doe so. All *faire*, all *profitable*, all *vertuous*, is *good*, and these three things I thinke embrace all things, but their utter *contraries*; of which also *faire* may be *rich* and *vertuous*; *poore* may bee *vertuous* and *faire*; *vitious* may be *faire* and *rich*; so that *good* hath this good meanes to be *common*, that some subjects she can possesse intirely; and in subjects poysoned with *evill*, she can humbly ¹⁴ stoop to accompany the *evill*. And of *indifferent* things many things are become perfectly good by being *common*, as *customes* by use are made binding *Lawes*. But I remember nothing that is therefore *ill*, because it is *common*, but *Women*, of whom also; *They that are most common, are the best of that Occupation they professe*.



5.

That all things kill themselves.



o affect, yea to effect their owne *death* all living things are importuned, not by *Nature* only which perfects them, but by *Art* and *Education*, which perfects her. *Plants* quickened and inhabited by the most unworthy *soule*, which therefore neither *will* nor *worke*, affect an *end*, a *perfection*, a *death*; this they spend their *spirits* to attaine, this attained, they languish and wither. And by how much more they are by mans *Industry* warmed, cherished, and pampered; so much the more early they climbe to this *perfection*, this *death*. And if amongst *Men* not to *defend* be to *kill*, what a hainous *selfe-murther* is it, not to *defend* it *selfe*. This *defence* because *Beasts* neglect, they kill themselves, because they exceed us in *number*, *strength*, and a *lawlesse* liberty: yea, of *Horses* and other beafts, they that inherit *most* courage by being bred of *gallantest* parents, and by *Artificial* nursing are bettered, will runne to their owne *deaths*, neither sollicitated by *spurres* which they need not, nor by *honour* which they apprehend not. If then the *valiant* kill himselfe, who can excuse the *coward*? Or how shall *Man* bee free from this, since the *first* *Man* taught us this, except we cannot kill our selves, because he kill'd us all. Yet lest something should repaire this *Common* ruine, we daily kill our *bodies* with *surfeits*, and our mindes with *anguishes*. Of our *powers*, *remembring* kills our

memory; Of Affections, Lusting our lust; Of vertues, Giving kils liberality. And if these kill themselves, they do it in their best & supreme perfection: for after perfection immediately follows excessse, which changeth the natures and the names, and makes them not the same things. If then the best things kill themselves soonest, (for no affection endures, and all things labour to this perfection) all travell to their owne death, yea the frame of the whole World, if it were possible for God to be idle, yet because it began, must dye. Then in this idleness imagined in God, what could kill the world but it selfe, since out of it, nothing is?



6.

That it is possible to find some vertue in some Women.



I am not of that feard *Impudence* that I dare defend *Women*, or pronounce them good; yet we see *Physitians* allow some *vertue* in every *poyson*. Alas! why should we except *Women*? since certainly, they are good for *Phyficke* at least, so as some *wine* is good for a *feaver*. And though they be the *Occasioners* of many finnes, they are also the *Punishers* and *Revengeers* of the same finnes: For I have seldome seene one which consumes his *substance* and *body* upon them, escape *diseases*, or *beggery*; and this is their *Iustice*. And if *suum cuiq;* dare, bee the fulfilling of all *Civill Iustice*, they are *most iust*; for they deny that which is theirs to no man.

Tanquam non liceat nulla puella negat.

And who may doubt of great wisedome in them, that doth but observe with how much labour and cunning our *Iusticers* and other *dispensers* of the *Lawes* study to imbrace them: and how zealously our *Preachers* dehort men from them, onely by urging their *subtilties*, and *policies*, and *wisedome*, which are in them? Or who can deny them a good measure of *Fortitude*, if hee consider how *valiant men* they have overthrowne, and being

themselves overthrowne, how much and how patiently they beare? And though they bee most *intemperate*, I care not, for I undertooke to furnish them with *some vertue*, not with *all*. *Necessity*, which makes even bad things good, prevails also for them, for wee must say of them, as of some sharpe pinching *Lawes*; If men were free from *infirmities*, they were needlesse. These or none must serve for *reasons*, and it is my great happiness that *Examples* prove not *Rules*, for to confirme this *Opinion*, the World yeelds not *one Example*.



7.

That Old men are more fantastike then Young.



WHO reads this *Paradox* but thinks mee more *fantastike* now, than I was yesterday, when I did not think thus: And if one day make this sensible change in men, what will the burthen of many yeeres? To bee *fantastike* in young men is *conceitfull distemperature*, and a witty *madnesse*; but in old men, whose senses are withered, it becomes *naturall*, therefore more full and perfect. For as when wee *sleepe* our *fancy* is most strong; so it is in *age*, which is a *slumber* of the *deepe sleepe of death*. They tax us of *Inconstancy*, which in themselves young they allowed; so that reprooving that which they did approve, their *Inconstancy* exceedeth ours, because they have changed *once more* then wee. Yea, they are more idly buied in *conceited apparell* then wee; for we, when we are *melancholy*, weare *blacke*; when *lustye*, *greene*; when *forfaken*, *tawney*; pleasing our owne *inward* affections, leaving them to others indifferent; but they prescribe *lawes*, and constraine the *Noble*, the *Scholer*, the *Merchant*, and all *Estates* to a certaine *habit*. The old men of our time have changed with patience their owne *bodies*, much of their *lawes*, much of their *languages*; yea their *Religion*, yet they accuse us. To be *Amorous* is proper and *naturall* in a young man, but in an old man most *fantastike*. And that *ridling humour* of *Iealoufie*, which seekes and would not finde, which

requires and repents his knowledge, is in them most common, yet most *fantastike*. Yea, that which falls never in *young men*, is in them most *fantastike* and *naturall*, that is, *Covetousnesse*; even at their *journeyes end* to make great provision. Is any *habit* of *young men* so *fantastike*, as in the hottest seasons to be *double-gowned* or *hooded* like our *Elders*? Or seemes it so *ridiculous* to weare long haire, as to weare *none*. Truly, as among the *Philosophers*, the *Skeptike*, which *doubts all*, was more contentious, then either the *Dogmatike* which *affirmes*, or *Academike* which *denyes all*; so are these uncertaine *Elders*, which both calls them *fantastike* which follow others *inventions*, and them also which are led by their owne humorous suggestion, more *fantastike* then other.



8.

That Nature is our worst Guide.

Shall she be *guide* to all *Creatures*, which is her selfe one? Or if she also have a *guide*, shall any *Creature* have a better guide then wee? The affections of *lust* and *anger*, yea even to erre is *naturall*; shall we follow these? Can shee be a good *guide* to us, which hath corrupted not us onely but her selfe? Was not the *first man*, by the desire of *knowledge*, corrupted even in the *whitest integrity* of *Nature*? And did not *Nature* (if *Nature* did any thing) infuse into him this desire of *knowledge*, and so this *corruption* in him, into us? If by *Nature* wee shall understand our *essence*, our *definition*, or *reason*, *nobleneffe*, then this being alike common to all (the *Idiot* and the *Wizard* being equally *reasonable*) why should not all men having equally all one *nature*, follow one course? Or if we shall understand our *inclinations*; alas! how unable a guide is that which followes the *temperature* of our *flimie bodies*? for we cannot say that we derive our *inclinations*, our *mindes*, or *soules* from our *Parents* by any way: to say that it is *all from all*, is *error* in *reason*, for then with the first nothing remaines; or is a *part from all*, is *errour* in *experience*, for then this *part* equally imparted to many children, would like *Gavel-kind lands*, in few generations become nothing; or to say it by *communication*, is *errour* in *Divinity*, for to communicate the *ability* of

communicating *whole effence* with any but God, is utter *blasphemy*. And if thou hit thy *Fathers nature* and *inclination*, he also had his *Fathers*, and so climbing up, all comes of one man, and have one *nature*, all shall imbrace one course; but that cannot bee, therefore our *complexions* and whole *bodies*, wee inherit from *Parents*; our *inclinations* and minds follow that: For our minde is heavy in our *bodies afflictions*, and rejoyceth in our *bodies pleasure*: how then shall this *nature* governe us, that is governed by the worst part of us? *Nature though oft chafed away, it will returne*; 'tis true, but those *good motions* and *inspirations* which be our guides must bee wooed, ²³*courted*, and *welcomed*, or else they abandon us. And that old *Axiome, nihil invita, &c.* must not be said thou *shalt*, but thou wilt doe nothing against *Nature*; so *unwilling* he notes us to curbe our *naturall appetites*. Wee call our *bastards* alwayes our *naturall issue*, and we define a *Foole* by nothing so ordinary, as by the name of *naturall*. And that poore knowledge whereby we conceive what *raine* is, what *wind*, what *thunder*, wee call *Metaphysicke, supernaturall*; such *small* things, such *no* things doe we allow to our pliant *Natures* apprehension. Lastly, by following her, we lose the pleasant, and lawfull commodities of this life, for wee shall drinke water and eate rootes, and those not sweet and delicate, as now by Mans *art* and *industry* they are made: we shall lose all the necessities of *societies, lawes, arts, and sciences*, which are all the workmanship of *Man*: yea we shall lack the last *best refuge* of misery, *death*; because *no death is naturall*: for if yee will not dare to call all *death violent* (though I see not why *sicknesses* be not *violences*) yet *causes* of all *deaths* proceed of the *defect* of that which *nature* made perfect, and would preserve, and therefore all against *nature*.



9.

That only Cowards dare dye.



*E*xtreames are equally removed from the *meane*; so that headlong *desperatenesse* asmuch offends true *valour*, as backward *Cowardice*: of which sort I reckon justly all *un-inforced deaths*. When will your *valiant* man dye of necessity? so *Cowards* suffer what cannot be avoided: and to runne into *death unimportun'd*, is to runne into the first condemned *desperatenesse*. Will he dye when he is *rich* and *happy*? then by living he may doe more good: and in *afflictions* and *miseries*, *death* is the chosen refuge of *Cowards*.

Fortiter ille facit, qui miser esse potest.

But it is taught and practised among our *Galants*, that rather than our reputations suffer any *maim*, or we any *miserie*, wee shall offer our *breasts* to the *Cannons* mouth, yea to our *swords* points: And this seemes a very *brave* and a very *climbing* (which is a *Cowardly*, earthly, and indeed a very *groveling*) *spirit*. Why doe they *chaine* these slaves to the *Gallyes*, but that they thrust their *deaths*, and would at every loose leape into the *sea*? Why doe they take weapons from *condemned* men, but to barre them of that ease which *Cowards* affect, a *speedy death*. Truly this *life* is a *tempest*, and a *warfare*, and he which *dares dye*, to escape the *anguish* of it, seems to mee, but so *valiant*,

as hee which dares *hang* himfelfe, left hee be *preft* to the warres. I have feene one in that extremity of *melancholy*, which was then become *madneffe*, to make his owne *breath* an *Instrument* to stay his breath, and labour to choake himfelfe, but alas! he was *mad*. And we knew another that languifhed under the *oppreffion* of a poore *disgrace* fo much, that hee tooke more *paines to dye*, then would have ferved to have nourifhed *life* and *fpirit* enough to have outlived his *disgrace*. What *Foole* will call this *Cowardlineffe*, *Valour*? or this *Baseneffe*, *Humility*? And laftly, of thefe men which dye the *Allegoricall death* of entring into *Religion*, how few are found fit for any fhew of *valiancy*? but onely a *foft* and *fupple metall*, made onely for *Cowardly folitarineffe*.



10.

*That a Wise Man is knowne by much
laughing.*



*R*ide, si sapias, ô puella ride; If thou beest wife,
laugh: for since the powers of discourse,
reason, and laughter, bee equally proper unto
Man onely, why shall not hee be onely most
wise, which hath most use of laughing, aswell
as he which hath most of reasoning and
discoursing? I alwaies did, and shall understand
that Adage;

Per risum multum possis cognoscere stultum,

That by much laughing thou maist know there is a foole, not,
that the laughers are fooles, but that among them there is some
foole, at whome wifemen laugh: which moved *Erasmus* to put
this as his first *Argument* in the mouth of his *Folly*, that shee
made *Beholders* laugh: for fooles are the most laughed at, and
laugh the least themselves of any. And *Nature* saw this faculty
to be so necessary in man, that shee hath beene content that
by more causes we should be importuned to laugh, then to the
exercise of any other power; for things in themselves utterly
contrary, beget this effect; for wee laugh both at witty and
absurd things: At both which sorts I have seen Men laugh so

long, and *so earnestly*, that at last they have wept that they could laugh no more. And therefore the *Poet* having described the quietnesse of a *wife retired man*, faith in one, what we have said before in many lines; *Quid facit Canius tuus? ridet*. We have received that even the *extremity* of laughing, yea of weeping also, hath beene accounted *wisedome*: And that *Democritus* and *Heraclitus*, the lovers of these *Extremes*, have been called *lovers of wisedome*. Now among our *wisemen* I doubt not, but many would be found who would laugh at *Heraclitus* weeping, none which weepe at *Democritus* laughing. At the hearing of *Comedies* or other witty reports, I have noted some, which not understanding *jest*s, &c. have yet chosen this as the best meanes to seeme *wise* and *understanding*, to laugh when their *Companions* laugh; and I have presumed them *ignorant*, whom I have seene *unmoved*. A *foole* if he come into a *Princes Court*, and see a *gay* man leaning at the wall, so *glistering*, and so *painted* in many colours that he is hardly discerned from one of the *pictures* in the *Arras*, hanging his body like an *Iron-bound-chest*, girt in and thicke ribb'd with *broad gold laces*, may (and commonly doth) envy him. But alas! shall a *wiseman*, which may not onely not envy, but not pitty this *monster*, do nothing? Yes, let him laugh. And if one of these *hot cholerike firebrands*, which nourish themselves by quarrelling, and kindling others, spit upon a *foole* one *sparke* of disgrace, he, like a *thatcht house* quickly burning, may bee angry; but the *wiseman*, as cold as the *Salamander*, may not onely not be angry with him, but not be sorry for him; therefore let him laugh: so he shall be knowne a Man, because he can laugh, a *wise Man* that hee knowes at *what* to laugh, and a *valiant Man* that he dares laugh: for he that laughs is justly reputed more *wise*, then at whom it is laughed. And hence I thinke proceeds that which in these later *formall* times I have much noted; that now when our *superstitious civility* of manners is become a mutuall tickling flattery of one another, almost every man affecteth an *humour* of *jesting*, and is content to be *deject*, and to *deforme* himselfe, yea become *foole* to no other end that I can spie, but to give his *wife Companion*

³⁸
occasion to *laugh*: and to shew themselves in *promptnesse* of
laughing is so great in *wifemen*, that I thinke all *wifemen*, if
any *wifeman* do reade this *Paradox*, will *laugh* both at it and
me.



11.

*That the gifts of the Body are better then
those of the Minde.*



I say againe, that the *body* makes the *minde*, not that it created it a *minde*, but *formes* it a *good* or a *bad mind*; and this *minde* may be confounded with *soule* without any violence or injustice to *Reason* or *Philosophy*: then the *soule* it seemes is enabled by our *body*, not this by it. My *Body* licenseth my *soule* to see the Worlds *beauties* through mine *eyes*; to *heare* pleasant things through mine *eaes*; and affords it apt *Organs* for the conveiance of all perceivable *delight*. But alas! my *soule* cannot make any *part*, that is not of it selfe disposed, to *see* or *heare*, though without doubt she be as able and as willing to see *behind* as *before*. Now if my *soule* would say, that she enables any part to taste these pleasures, but is her selfe onely delighted with those rich *sweetnesses* which her *inward eyes* and *senses* apprehend, she should dissemble; for I see her often solaced with *beauties*, which she sees through mine *eyes*, and with *musicke* which through mine *eaes* she heares. This *perfection* then my *body* hath, that it can impart to my *minde* all his *pleasures*; and my *minde* hath still many, that she can neither teach my *indisposed* part her *faculties*, nor to the best *espoused* parts shew it *beauty* of *Angels*, of *Musicke*, of *Spheres*, whereof

he boasts the *contemplation*. Are *chastity*, *temperance*, and *fortitude* gifts of the *mind*? I appeale to *Physitians* whether the *cause* of these be not in the *body*, *health* is the gift of the *body*, and *patience* in lickenesse the gift of the *minde*: then who will say that *patience* is as good a happinesse, as *health*, when wee must be extremely *miserable* to purchase this *happinesse*. And for nourishing of *civill societies* and *mutuall love* amongst men, which is our *chiefe end* while wee are men; I say, this *beauty*, *presence*, and *proportion* of the *body*, hath a more *masculine* force in begetting this *love*, then the *vertues* of the *minde*: for it strikes us *suddenly*, and possesseth us *immoderately*; when to know those *vertues* requires some *Iudgement* in him which shall discern, a *long time* and *conversation* betweene them. And even at last how much of our ³²~~faith~~ and *beleefe* shall we be driven to bestow, to assure our selves that these *vertues* are not *counterfeited*: for it is the same to *be*, and *seeme vertuous*, because that he that hath *no vertue*, can *dissemble* none, but he which hath a *little*, may *gild* and *enamell*, yea and transforme much *vice* into *vertue*: For allow a man to be *discreet* and *flexible* to *complaints*, which are great *vertuous* gifts of the *minde*, this *discretion* will be to him the *soule* & *Elixir* of all *vertues*, so that touched with this, even *pride* shall be made *humility*; and *Cowardice*, honourable and wife *valour*. But in things *seene* there is not this danger, for the *body* which thou lovest and esteemest *faire*, is *faire*; certainly if it bee not *faire* in *perfection*, yet it is *faire* in the same *degree* that thy *Iudgement* is good. And in a *faire body*, I doe seldome suspect a *disproportioned minde*, and as seldome hope for a *good* in a *deformed*. When I see a *goodly house*, I assure my selfe of a *worthy possessor*, from a *ruinous weather-beaten building* I turn away, because it seems either stuffed with *varlets* as a *Prison*, or handled by an *unworthy* and *negligent tenant*, that so suffers the *waste* thereof. And truly the gifts of *Fortune*, which are *riches*, are onely *handmaids*, yea *Pandars* ³⁴~~of~~ the *bodies pleasure*; with their service we nourish *health*, and preserve *dainty*, and wee buy *delights*; so that *vertue* which must be loved for it *selfe*, and respects no further *end*, is indeed

nothing: And riches, whose end is the good of the body, cannot be so perfectly good, as the end whereto it levels.



12.

That Virginitie is a Vertue.

call not that *Virginitie* a *vertue*, which resideth only in the *Bodies integrity*; much lesse if it be with a purpose of perpetuall keeping it: for then it is a most inhumane vice—But I call that *Virginitie* a *vertue* which is willing and desirous to yeeld itselfe upon honest and lawfull termes, when just reason requireth; and untill then, is kept with a modest chastity of Body and Mind. Some perchance will say that *Virginitie* is in us by *Nature*, and therefore no *vertue*. True, as it is in us by *Nature*, it is neither a *Vertue* nor *Vice*, and is onely in the body: (as in Infants, Children, and such as are incapable of parting from it). But that *Virginitie* which is in Man or Woman of perfect age, is not in them by *Nature*: *Nature* is the greatest enemy to it, and with most subtile allurements seeks the over-throw of it, continually beating against it with her *Engines*, and giving such forcible assaults to it, that it is a strong and more then ordinary *vertue* to hold out till marriage. *Ethick Philosophy* faith, *That no Vertue is corrupted, or is taken away by that which is good*: Hereupon some may say, that *Virginitie* is therefore no *vertue*, being taken away by marriage. *Virginitie* is no otherwise taken away by marriage, then is the light of the starres by a greater light (the light of the Sun:) or as a lesse Title is taken away by a greater: (an Esquire by being created an Earle) yet

Virginity is a *vertue*, and hath her Throne in the middle: The extreame is, in *Exceſſe*; to violate it before marriage; in defect, not to marry. In ripe years as ſoon as reaſon perſwades, and opportunity admits, Theſe extreame are equally removed from the mean: The exceſſe proceeds from *Luſt*, the defect from *Peeviſhneſſe*, *Pride* and *Stupidity*. There is an old Proverb, That, *they that dy maids, muſt lead Apes in Hell*. An Ape is a ridiculous and unprofitable Beaſt, whoſe fleſh is not good for meat, nor its back for burden, nor is it commodious to keep an houſe: and perchance for the unprofitableneſſe of this Beaſt did this proverb come up: For ſurely nothing is more unprofitable ³⁶in the Commonwealth of *Nature*, then they that dy old maids, becauſe they reſuſe to be uſed to that end for which they were only made. The Ape bringeth forth her young, for the moſt part by twins; that which ſhe loves beſt, ſhe killeth by preſſing it too hard: ſo fooliſh maids ſoothing themſelves with a falſe conceit of *vertue*, in fond obſtinacie, live and die maids; and ſo not only kill in themſelves the *vertue* of *Virginity*, and of a *Vertue* make it a Vice, but they alſo accuſe their parents in condemning marriage. If this application hold not touch, yet there may be an excellent one gathered from an Apes tender love to Conies in keeping them from the Weaſel and Ferret. From this ſimilitude of an Ape & an old Maid did the aforeſaid proverb firſt ariſe. But alas, there are ſome old Maids that are *Virgins* much againſt their wills, and fain would change their *Virgin-life* for a *Married*: ſuch if they never have had any offer of fit Huſbands, are in ſome ſort excuſable, and their willingneſſe, their deſire to marry, and their forbearance from all diſhoneſt, and unlawful copulation, may be a kind of inclination to *vertue*, although not *Vertue* it ſelfe. This *Virtue* of *Virginity* (though it be ſmall and fruitleſſe) it is an extraordinary, and no ³⁷common *Vertue*. All other *Vertues* lodge in the *Will* (it is the *Will* that makes them *vertues*.) But it is the unwillingneſſe to keep it, the deſire to forſake it, that makes this a *vertue*. As in the naturall generation and formation made of the ſeed in the womb of a woman, the body is joynted and organized about the 28 day, and ſo it begins to be no more an *Embrion*, but

capable as a matter prepared to its form to receive the soule, which faileth not to infinuate and innew it selfe into the body about the fortieth day; about the third month it hath motion and sense: Even so *Virginity* is an *Embrion*, an unfashioned lump, till it attain to a certain time, which is about twelve years of age in women, fourteen in men, and then it beginneth to have the soule of *Love* infused into it, and to become a *vertue*: There is also a certain limited time when it ceaseth to be a *vertue*, which in men is about forty, in women about thirty years of age: yea, the losse of so much time makes their *Virginity* a *Vice*, were not their endeavour wholly bent, and their desires altogether fixt upon marriage: In Harvest time do we not account it a great vice of sloath and negligence in a Husband-man, to overslip a week or ten dayes after his fruits ³⁸are fully ripe; May we not much more account it a more heynous vice, for a *Virgin* to let her Fruit (*in potentia*) consume and rot to nothing, and to let the *vertue* of her *Virginity* degenerate into *Vice*, (for *Virginity* ever kept is ever lost.) Avarice is the greatest deadly sin next Pride: it takes more pleasure in hoarding Treasure then in making use of it, and will neither let the possessor nor others take benefit by it during the Misers life; yet it remains intire, and when the Miser dies must come to some body. *Virginity* ever kept, is a vice far worse then Avarice, it will neither let the possessor nor others take benefit by it, nor can it be bequeathed to any: with long keeping it decays and withers, and becomes corrupt and nothing worth. Thus seeing that *Virginity* becomes a vice in defect, by exceeding a limited time; I counsell all female *Virgins* to make choyce of some *Paracelsian* for their Physitian, to prevent the death of that *Vertue*: The *Paracelsians* (curing like by like) say, That if the lives of living Creatures could be taken down, they would make us immortall. By this rule, female *Virgins* by a discreet marriage should swallow down into their *Virginity* another *Virginity*, and devour such a life & spirit into their ³⁹womb, that it might make them as it were, immortall here on earth, besides their perfect immortality in heaven: And that *Vertue* which otherwise would putrifie and corrupt, shall then be

complete; and shall be recorded in Heaven, and enrolled here on Earth; and the name of *Virgin* shall be exchanged for a far more honorable name, *A Wife*.



PROBLEMS

1.

Why have Bastards best Fortune?



Because *Fortune* herselfe is a *Whore*, but such are not most indulgent to their *issue*; the old naturall reason (but those meetings in *stolne love* are most *vehement*, and so contribute more *spirit* then the *easie* and *lawfull*) might governe me, but that now I see *Mistresses* are become *domestike* and *inordinary*, and they and wives waite but by *turnes*, and *agree* aswell as they had lived in the *Arke*. The old Morall reason (that *Bastards* inherit *wickednesse* from their *Parents*, and so are in a better way to *preferment* by having a *stocke* before-hand, then those that build all their *fortune* upon the *poore* and *weake* stocke of *Originall sinne*) might prevaile with me, but that since wee are fallen into such times, as now the *world* might *spare* the *Divell*, because *she* could be bad enough without *him*. I see men *scorne* to be *wicked* by *example*, or to bee *beholding* to others for their *damnation*. It seems reasonable, that since *Lawes* rob them of *succession* in *civill benefits*, they should have something else *equivalent*. As *Nature* (which is *Lawes patterne*) having

denyed Women *Conſtancy* to *one*, hath provided them with *cunning* to allure *many*; and ſo *Baſtards de jure* ſhould have better wits and *experience*. But beſides that by *experience* wee ſee many *fooles* amongſt them, wee ſhould take from them one of their chiefeſt helpes to *preferment*, and we ſhould deny them to be *fools*, and (that which is onely left) that Women chuſe *worthier* men then their *husbands*, is falſe *de facto*; either then it muſt bee that the *Church* having removed them from all place in the *publike Service* of *God*, they have better meanes then others to be *wicked*, and ſo *fortunate*: Or elſe becauſe the two *greateſt powers* in this *world*, the *Divell* and *Princes* concurre to their *greatneſſe*; the one giving *baſtardy*, the other *legitimation*: As *nature* frames and conſerves great *bodies* of *contraries*. Or the cauſe is, becauſe they abound moſt at *Court*, which is the *forge* where *fortunes* are made, or at leaſt the *ſhop* where they be *ſold*.



2.

Why Puritanes make long Sermons?

I^T needs not *perspicuoufnesse*, for God knowes they are plain enough: nor doe all of them use *Sem-briefe-Accents* for some of them have *crotchets* enough. It may bee they intend not to rife like *glorious Tapers* and *Torches*, but like *Thinne-wretched-ficke-watching-Candles*, which *languish* and are in a *Divine Consumption* from the first minute, yea in their *snuffe*, and *stink* when others are in their more profitable *glory*. I have thought sometimes, that out of *conscience*, they allow *long measure* to *course* ware. And sometimes, that *usurping* in that place a *liberty* to *speak freely* of *Kings*, they would *raigne* as long as they could. But now I thinke they doe it out of a *zealous* imagination, that, *It is their duty to preach on till their Auditory wake*.



3.

Why did the Divel reserve Jesuites till these latter dayes.



Did he know that our *Age* would deny the *Devils* *possessing*, and therfore provided by these to *possesse* men and kingdomes? Or to end the *disputation* of *Schoolemen*, why the *Divell* could not make *lice* in *Egypt*; and whether those things hee *presented* there, might be *true*, hath he sent us a *true* and *reall* *plague*, worfe than those *ten*? Or in *ostentation* of the *greatnesse* of his *Kingdome*, which even *division* cannot *shake*, doth he send us these which *disagree* with all the rest? Or knowing that our *times* should discover the *Indies*, and abolish their *Idolatry*, doth he send these to give them *another* for it? Or peradventure they have beene in the *Roman Church* these *thousand yeeres*, though we have called them by *other names*.



4.

*Why is there more variety of Green then of
other Colours?*



I^T is becaufe it is the figure of *Youth* wherin *nature* wuld provide as many *green*, as *youth* hath *affections*; and so present a *Sea-green* for *profuse wasters* in *voyages*; a *Grasse-green* for *sudden new men enobled* from *Grafiers*; and a *Goose-greene* for such *Polititians* as pretend to preserve the *Capitol*. Or else *Prophetically* foreseeing an *age*, wherein they shall all *hunt*. And for such as *misdemeane* themselves a *Willow-greene*; For *Magistrates* must aswell have *Fasces* born before them to *chastize* the *small* offences, as *Secures* to cut off the *great*.



5.

*Why doe young Lay-men ſo much ſtudy
Divinity.*

Is it becauſe others tending buſily *Churches* preferment neglect *ſtudy*? Or had the *Church* of *Rome* ſhut up all our wayes, till the *Lutherans* broke downe their uttermoſt ſtubborne doores, and the *Calviniſts* picked their inwardeſt and ſubtleſt lockes? Surely the *Devill* cannot be ſuch a *Foole* to hope that he ſhall make this ſtudy contemptible, by making it common. Nor that as the *Dwellers* by the River *Origus* are ſaid (by drawing infinite ditches to ſprinkle their barren Country) to have exhausted and intercepted their maine channell, and ſo loſt their more profitable courſe to the ſea; ſo we, by providing every ones ſelfe, divinity enough for his own uſe, ſhould neglect our *Teachers* and *Fathers*. Hee cannot hope for better hereſies ¹⁶ then hee hath had, nor was his *Kingdome* ever ſo much advanced by debating *Religion* (though with ſome aſperſions of *Error*) as by a dull and ſtupid ſecurity, in which many groſe things are ſwallowed. Poſſible out of ſuch an ambition as we have now, to ſpeake plainly and fellow-like with *Lords* and *Kings*, wee thinke alſo to acquaint our ſelves with *Gods ſecrets*: Or perchance when we ſtudy it by mingling humane reſpects, It is not *Divinity*.



6.

*Why hath the common Opinion afforded
Women Soules?*

I^T is agreed that wee have not so much from them as any *part* of either our *mortall soules* of *sense*, or *growth*, and we deny *soules* to others equal to them in all but in *speech* for which they are beholding to their *bodily instruments*: For perchance an *Oxes* heart, or a *Goates*, or a *Foxes*, or a *Serpents* would speake just so, if it were in the *breast*, and could move that *tongue* and *jawes*. Have they so many *advantages* and *meanes* to hurt us (for, ever their *loving* destroyed us) that we dare not *displease* them, but give them what they will? And so when some call them *Angels*, some *Goddeffes*, and the *Palpulian Heretikes* made them *Bishops*, wee descend so much with the streame, to allow them *soules*? Or doe we somewhat (in this dignifying of them) flatter *Princes* and *great Personages* that ⁴⁸are so much governed by them? Or do we in that *easinesse* and *prodigality*, wherein we daily lose our owne *soules* to we care not whom, so labour to perswade our selves, that sith a *woman* hath a *soule*, a *soule* is no great matter? Or doe wee lend them *soules* but for *use*, since they for our sakes, give their *soules* againe, and their *bodies* to boote? Or perchance because the *Deuill* (who is all *soule*) doth most *mischiefe*, and for

convenience and *proportion*, becaufe they would come neerer him, wee allow them some foules; and fo as the *Romanes* naturalized some *Provinces* in revenge, and made them *Romans*, onely for the *burthen* of the *Common-wealth*; fo we have given *women* foules onely to make them capable of *damnation*?



7.

Why are the Fairest, Falsest?

meane not of false *Alchemy Beauty*, for then the *question* should be inverted, *Why are the Falsest, Fairest?* It is not onely because they are *much solicited* and *fought* for, so is *gold*, yet it is not so *common*; and this *suite* to them, should teach them their *value*, and make them more *reserved*. Nor is it because the *delicatest blood* hath the *best spirits*, for what is that to the *flesh*? perchance such *constitutions* have the *best wits*, and there is no *proportionable subject*, for *Womens wit*, but *deceit*? doth the *minde* so follow the *temperature* of the *body*, that because those *complexions* are aptest to change, the *mind* is therefore so? Or as *Bells* of the *purest metall* retaine their *tinkling* and *sound* largest; so the *memory* of the last *pleasure* lasts longer in these, and disposeth them to the next. But sure it is not in the *complexion*, for those that doe but thinke themselves *faire*, are presently inclined to this *multiplicity* of *loves*, which being but *faire in concept* are *false in deed*: and so perchance when they are *borne* to this *beauty*, or have *made* it, or have dream'd it, they easily believe all *addresses* and *applications* of every *man*, out of a *sense* of their own *worthiness* to be directed to them, which others *less worthy* in their own thoughts apprehend not, or discredit. But I think the *true reason* is, that being like *gold* in many properties (as that *all snatch* at them, but the *worst*

possess them, that they care not how deep we dig for them, and that by the Law of nature, *Occupandi conceditur*) they would be like also in this, that as Gold to make it self of use admits alloy, so they, that they may be tractable, mutable, and currant, have to alloy *Falshood*.



8.

Why Venus-star only doth cast a shadow?

Is it because it is nearer the earth? But they whose profession it is to see that nothing be done in heaven without their consent (as *Re* — says in himself of *Astrologers*) have bid *Mercury* to be nearer. Is it because the works of *Venus* want shadowing, covering and dignifying? But those of *Mercury* need it more; For Eloquence, his occupation, is all shadow and colours; let our life be a sea, and then our reasons and even passions are wide enough to carry us whether we should go, but Eloquence is a storm and tempest that miscarries: and who doubts that Eloquence which must persuade people to take a yoke of sovereignty (and then beg and make Laws to tie them faster, and then give money to the invention, repair and strengthen it) needs more shadows and coloring, then to persuade any man or woman to that which is natural. And *Venus* markets are so natural, that when we solicit the best way (which is by *marriage*) our persuasions work not so much to draw a woman to us, as against her nature to draw her from all other besides. And so when we go against nature, and from *Venus-work* (for marriage is chastitie) we need shadowes and colours, but not else. In *Seneca's* time, it was a course, an un-Roman and a contemptible thing even in a *Matron*, not to have had a *Love* beside her husband, which though the Law required

not at their hands, yet they did it *zealously* out of the Council of Custom and fashion, which was *venery* of *supererrogation*:

Et te spectator plusquam delectat Adulter,

saith *Martial*: And *Horace*, because many lights would not shew him enough, created many *Images* of the same Object by wainscoting his chamber with looking-glasses: so that *Venus* flies not light, as much as *Mercury*, who creeping into our understanding, our darkness would be defeated, if he were perceived. Then either this *shadow* confesseth that same dark Melancholy Repentance which accompanies; or that so violent [fire](#), needs some shadowy refreshing and intermission: Or else light signifying both day and youth, and shadow both night and age, she pronounceth by this that she professeth both all persons and times.



9.

*Why is Venus-star multinominous, called both
Hesperus and Vesper.*



HE Moon hath as many names, but not as she is a star, but as she hath divers governments; but *Venus* is *multinominous* to give example to her *prostitute disciples*, who so often, either to renew or refresh themselves towards lovers, or to disguise themselves from *Magistrates*, are to take new names. It may be she takes new names after her many functions, for as she is supream Monarch of all Suns at large (which is *lust*) so is she joyned in Commiſſion with all *Mythologicks*, with *Juno*, *Diana*, and all others for marriage. It may be becauſe of the divers names to her ſelf, for her affections have more names than any vice: ſcilicet, *Pollution*, *Fornication*, *Adultery*, *Lay-Inceſt*, *Church-Inceſt*, *Rape*, *Sodomy*, *Maſtupration*, *Maſturbation*, and a thouſand others. Perchance her divers names ſhewed her appliableneſs to divers men, for *Neptune* diſtilled and wet her in love, the Sun warms and melts her, *Mercury* perſwaded and ſwore her, *Jupiters* authority ſecured, and *Vulcan* hammer'd her. As *Hesperus* ſhe preſents you with her *bonum utile*, becauſe it is wholeſomeſt in the morning: As *Vesper* with her *bonum delectabile*, becauſe it is pleaſanteſt in the evening. And becauſe induſtrious men riſe and endure with the Sun in their civil

businesses, this Star casts them up a little before, and remembers them again a little after for her business; for certainly,

Venit Hesperus, ite capellae:

was spoken to Lovers in the persons of *Goats*.



10.

Why are New Officers least oppressing?

Must the old Proverbe, that *Old dogs bite forest*, be true in all kinde of *dogs*? Me thinkes the fresh *memory* they have of the *mony* they parted with for the *place*, should hasten them for the *re-imbursing*: And perchance they doe but seeme easie to their *suiters*; who (as all other *Patients*) doe account all change of paine, easie. But if it bee so, it is either because the sodain *sense & contentment* of the *honor* of the *place*, retards and remits the rage of their *profits*, and so having stayd their *stomackes*, they can forbear the second *course* a while: Or having overcome the *steepest* part of the *hill*, and clambered above *Competitions* and *Oppositions* they dare loyter, and take breath: Perchance being come from *places*, where they tasted *no gaine*, a little seems much to them at first, for it is long before ⁵⁷ a *Christian conscience* overtakes, or straies into an *Officers heart*. It may be that out of the *generall disease* of all men not to love the *memory* of a *predecessor*, they seeke to disgrace them by such *easinesse*, and make good *first impressions*, that so having drawn much *water* to their *Mill*, they may afterward *grind* at ease: For if from the rules of good *Horse-manship*, they thought it wholesome to *jet* out in a moderate *pace*, they should also take up towards their *journeys end*, not mend their pace continually, and *gallop* to their *Innes-doore*, the *grave*;

except perchance their *conscience* at that time so touch them, that they thinke it an *injury* and *damage* both to him that must *sell*, and to him that must *buy* the *Office* after their *death*, and a kind of *dilapidation* if they by continuing *honest* should discredit the *place*, and bring it to a *lower-rent*, or *under-value*.



11.

*Why does the Poxe so much affect to
undermine the Nose?*



*Per*chance faith true, That every Disease hath his exaltation in some part certaine. But why this in the Nose? Is there so much mercy in this disease, that it provides that one should not smell his own stinck? Or hath it but the common fortune, that being begot and bred in obscurest and secretest places, because therefore his serpentine crawling and insinuation should not be suspected, nor seen, he comes soonest into great place, and is more able to destroy the worthiest member, then a disease better born? Perchance as mice defeat Elephants by knowing their *Proboscis*, which is their Nose, this wretched Indian Vermine practiseth to doe the same upon us. Or as the ancient furious Custome and Connivency of some Lawes, that ⁵⁹one might cut off their Nose whome he deprehended in Adulterie, was but a Tipe of this; And that now more charitable lawes having taken away all Revenge from particular hands, this common Magistrate and Executioner is come to do the same office invisibly? Or by withdrawing this conspicuous part, the Nose, it warnes us from all adventuring upon that Coast; for it is as good a mark to take in a flag as to hang one out. Possibly heate, which is more potent and active then

cold, thought her selfe injured, and the Harmony of the world out of tune, when cold was able to shew the high-way to Noses in *Muscovia*, except she found the meanes to doe the same in other Countries. Or because by the consent of all, there is an Analogy, Proportion, and affection between the Nose and that part where this disease is first contracted, and therefore *Heliogabalus* chose not his Minions in the Bath but by the Nose: And *Albertus* had a knavish meaning when he preferred great Noses; And the licentious Poet was *Naso Poeta*. I think this reason is nearest truth, That the Nose is most compassionate with this part: Except this be nearer, that it is reasonable that this Disease in particular should affect the most eminent and perspicuous part, which in general doth affect to take hold of the most eminent and conspicuous men.



12.

Why die none for Love now?



Because women are become eafyer. Or because these later times have provided mankind of more new means for the destroying of themselves and one another, *Pox, Gunpowder, Young marriages, and Controversies in Religion.* Or is there in true History no Precedent or Example of it? Or perchance some die so, but are not therefore worthy the remembring or speaking of?



13.

Why do Women delight much in Feathers?

They think that Feathers imitate wings, and so shew their restlessness and instability. As they are in matter, so they would be in name, like *Embroiderers, Painters*, and such *Artificers* of curious *vanities*, which the vulgar call *Pluminaries*. Or else they have feathers for the same reason, which moves them to love the unworthiest men, which is, that they may be thereby excusable in their inconstancy and often changing.



14.

Why doth not Gold soyl the fingers?



oth it direct all the venom to the heart? Or is it because bribing should not be discovered? Or because that should pay purely, for which pure things are given, as *Love, Honor, Justice* and Heaven? Or doth it seldom come into innocent hands but into such as for former foulness you cannot discern this?



15.

*Why do great men of all dependants, chuse to
preserve their little Pimps?*

IT is not because they are got nearest their secrets, for they whom they bring come nearer. Nor commonly because they and their bawds have lain in one belly, for then they should love their brothers aswel. Nor because they are witnessses of their weaknes, for they are weak ones. Either it is because they have a double hold and obligation upon their masters for providing them surgery and remedy after, aswel as pleasure before, and bringing them always such stuff, as they shal always need their service? Or because they may be received and entertained every where, and Lords fling off none but they such as they may destroy by it. Or perchance we deceive our selves, and every Lord having many, and, of necessity, some rising, we mark only these.



16.

*Why are Courtiers sooner Atheists then men of
other conditions?*

Is it because as *Physitians* contemplating Nature, and finding many abstruse things subject to the search of Reason, thinks therefore that all is so; so they (seeing mens destinies, mad at Court, neck out and in joynt there, War, Peace, Life and Death derived from thence) climb no higher? Or doth a familiarity with greatness, and daily conversation and acquaintance with it breed a contempt of all greatness? Or because that they see that opinion or need of one another, and fear makes the degrees of servants, Lords and Kings, do they think that God likewise for such Reason hath been mans Creator? Perchance it is because they see Vice prosper best there, and, burthened with sinne, doe they not, for their ease, endeavour to put off the feare and Knowledge of God, as facinorous men deny Magistracy? Or are the most Atheists in that place, because it is the foole that said in his heart, There is no God.



17.

Why are statesmen most incredulous?

Are they all wise enough to follow their excellent pattern *Tiberius*, who brought the senate to be diligent and industrious to believe him, were it never so opposite or diametrically, that it destroyed their very ends to be believed, as *Afinius Gallus* had almost deceived this man by believing him, and the Major and Aldermen of *London* in *Richard* the Third? Or are busineses (about which these men are conversant) so conjecturally, so subject to unsuspected interventions that they are therefore forc'd to speak oraculously, whisperingly, generally, and therefore elcapiingly, in the language of Almanack-makers for weather? Or are those (as they call them) *Arcana imperii*, as by whom the Prince provokes his lust, and by whom he vents it, ⁶⁷ of what Cloath his socks are, and such, so deep, and so irreveald, as any error in them is inexcusable? If these were the reasons, they would not only serve for state-busines. But why will they not tell true, what a Clock it is, and what weather, but abstain from truth of it, if it conduce not to their ends, as Witches will not name Jesus, though it be in a curse? eithere they know little out of their own Elements, or a Custom in one matter begets an habite in all. Or the lower sort imitate Lords, they their Princes, these their Prince. Or else they believe one another, and so never hear truth. Or they abstain from the little

Channel of truth, least, at last, they should *finde the fountain it
self, God.*



18.

*Why was Sir Walter Raleigh thought the fittest
Man, to write the Historie of these Times?*



AS it becaufe that being told at his Arraignement, that a Witnefs accusing himfelf had the ftrength of two; he may feem by Writing the illls of his own Time to be believed? Or is it, becaufe he might reenjoy thofe Times by the Meditation of them? Or becaufe if he fhould undertake higher Times, he doth not think, that he can come nearer to the Beginning of the World? Or becaufe like a Bird in a Cage, he takes his Tunes from every paffenger, that laft whiftled? Or becaufe he thinks not that the beft Echo which repeats moft of the Sentence, but that which repeats Lefs more plainly?



CHARACTERS

1.

The Character of a Scot at the first sight.



THIS first appearing in the *Charterhouse*, an Olive coloured Veluet suit owned him, which since became mous-colour, A pair of unskour'd stockings-gules, One indifferent shooe, his band of *Edenburgh*, and cuffs of *London*, both strangers to his shirt, a white feather in a hat that had bin sod, one onely cloak for the rain, which yet he made serve him for all weathers: A Barren-half-acre of Face, amidst whereof an eminent Nose advanced himself, like the new Mount at *Wansted*, overlooking his Beard, and all the wilde Country thereabouts; He was tended enough, but not well; for they were certain dumb creeping Followers, yet they made way for their Master, the Laird. At the first presentment his Breeches were his Sumpter, and his Packets, Trunks, Cloak-bags, Portmanteau's and all; He then grew a Knight-wright, and there is extant of his ware at 100*l.* 150*l.* and 200*l.* price. Immediately after this, he shifteth his suit, so did his Whore, and to a Bear-baiting they went, whither I followed them not, but *Tom. Thorney* did.



2.

The true Character of a Dunce.

HE hath a Soule drown'd in a lump of Flesh, or in a piece of Earth that *Prometheus* put not half his proportion of Fire into, a thing that hath neither edge of desire, nor feeling of affection in it, The most dangerous creature for confirming an *Atheist*, who would straight swear, his soul were nothing but the bare temperature of his body: He sleeps as he goes, and his thoughts seldom reach an inch further than his eyes; The most part of the faculties of his soul lye Fallow, or are like the restive Jades that no spur can drive forwards towards the pursuite of any worthy design; one of the most unprofitable of all Gods creatures, being as he is, a thing put clean besides his right use, made fitt for the cart & the flail, and by mischance Entangled amongst books and papers, a man cannot tel possible what he is now good for, save to move up and down and fill room, or to serve as *Animatum Instrumentum* for others to work withal in base Employments, or to be a foyl for better witts, or to serve (as They say monsters do) to set out the variety of nature, and Ornament of the Universe, He is meer nothing of himself, neither eates, nor drinkes, nor goes, nor spits but by imitation, for al which, he hath set forms & fashions, which he never varies, but sticks to, with the like plodding constancy that a milhors follows his trace, both the mules and the graces are

his hard Mitriffles though he daily Invoke them, though he
sacrifice *Hecatombs*, they still look a squint, you shall note him
oft (beside his dull eye and louting head, and a certain clammie
benum'd pace) by a fair displai'd beard, a Nightcap and a
gown, whose very wrinkles proclaim him the true genius of
formality, but of all others, his discourses and compositions best
speak him, both of them are much of one stuff & fashion, he
speaks just what his books or last company said unto him
without varying one whit & very seldom understands himself,
you may know by his discourse where he was last, for what he
read or heard yesterday he now dischargeth his memory or
⁷³notebook of, not his understanding, for it never came there;
what he hath he flings abroad at all adventures without
accommodating it to time, place, persons or occasions, he
commonly loseth himself in his tale, and flutters up and down
windles without recovery, and whatsoever next presents it self,
his heavie conceit seizeth upon and goeth along with, however
Heterogeneal to his matter in hand, his jests are either old flead
proverbs, or lean-starv'd-hackney-*Apophthegm's*, or poor verball
quips outworn by Servingmen, Tapsters and Milkmaids, even
laid aside by Balladers, He assents to all men that bring any
shadow of reason, and you may make him when he speaks most
Dogmatically, even with one breath, to averr pure
contradictions, His Compositions differ only *terminorum*
positione from Dreams, Nothing but rude heaps of Immaterial-
inchoherent drossie-rubbish-stuffe, promiscuously thrust up
together, enough to Infuse dullness and Barrenness of Conceit
into him that is so Prodiggall of his eares as to give the
hearing, enough to make a mans memory Ake with suffering
such dirtie stuffe cast into it, as unwellcome to any true conceit,
as Sluttish Morfells or Wallowish Potions to a Nice-Stomack
which whiles he empties himselfe of, it sticks in his Teeth nor
⁷⁴can he be Delivered without Sweate and Sighes, and Humms,
and Coughs enough to shake his Grandams teeth out of her
head; Heel spitt, and scratch, and yawn, and stamp, and turn
like sick men from one elbow to another, and Deserve as much
pitty during this torture as men in Fits of Tertian Feavors or

selfe lashing Penitentiaries; in a word, Rip him quite afunder, and examin every fhred of him, you fhall finde him to be juft nothing, but the fubject of Nothing, the object of contempt, yet fuch as he is you muft take him, for there is no hope he fhould ever become better.



21.

An Essay of Valour.

am of opinion that nothing is so potent either to procure or merit Love, as Valour, and I am glad I am so, for thereby I shall do my self much ease, because Valour never needs much wit to maintain it: To speak of it in it self, It is a quality which he that hath, shall have least need of, so the best League between Princes is a mutual fear of each other, it teacheth a man to value his reputation as his life, and chiefly to hold the Lye unsufferable, though being alone, he holds finds no hurt it doth him, It leaves it self to others censures, for he that brags of his own valour, dissuades others from believing it, It feareth a word no more than an Ague, It always makes good the Owner, for though he be generally held a fool, he shall seldom hear so much by word of mouth, and that enlargeth him more ¹⁶than any spectacles, for it maketh a little fellow be called a tall man, it yeilds the wall to none but a woman, whose weakness is her prerogative, or a man seconded with a woman as an usher, which always goes before his betters, It makes a man become the witness of his own words, and stand to whatever he hath said, and thinketh it a reproach to commit his reviling unto the Law, it furnisheth youth with action, and age with discourse, and both by futures, for a man must ever boast

himself in the present tense, and to come nearer home, nothing draws a woman like to it; for Valour towards men, is an Emblem of an ability towards women, a good quality signifies a better. Nothing is more behooffull for that Sex; for from it they receive protection, and we free from the danger of it: Nothing makes a shorter cut for obtaining, for a man of Arms is always void of Ceremony, which is the wall that stands between *Pyramus* and *Thiſbe*, that is, *Man* and *Woman*, for there is no pride in women but that which rebounds from our own baseneſſe (as Cowards grow valiant upon thoſe that are more Cowards) ſo that only by our pale aſking we teach them to deny, and by our ſhamefac'dneſſes, we put them in minde to ¹⁷⁷be modeſt, whereas indeed it is cunning *Rhetorick* to perſwade the hearers that they are that already which he would have them to be; This kinde of baſhfulneſſe is far from men of Valour, and eſpecially from ſouldiers, for ſuch are ever men (without doubt) forward and confident, loſing no time leaſt they ſhould loſe opportunity, which is the beſt Factor for a Lover, and becauſe they know women are given to diſſemble, they will never believe them when they deny, *Whilome* before this age of wit, and wearing black, were broke in upon us, there was no way known to win a Lady but by Tylting, Turnying, and riding through Forreſts, in which time theſe ſlender ſtriplings with little legs were held but of ſtrength enough to marry their widows, and even in our days there can be given no reaſon of the Inundation of Servingmen upon their Miſtreſſes, but (only) that uſually they carry their Maſters Weapons, and his Valour: To be accounted handſome, juſt, learned, or well favoured, all this carries no danger with it, but it is to be admitted to the Title of Valiant Acts, at leaſt the adventuring of his mortality, and al women take delight to hold him ſafe in their arms who hath ¹⁷⁸ſcaped thither through many dangers: To ſpeak at once, Man hath a priviledge in Valour; In clothes and good faces we but imitate women, and many of that Sex will not think much (as far as an anſwer goes) to diſſemble wit too. So then theſe neat youths, theſe women in mens apparel are too near a woman to be beloved of her, They be both of a Trade, but be grim of

aspect, and such a one as Glaſs dares take, and ſhe will deſire him for neatneſs and varietie; A ſkar in a mans face is the ſame that a mole in a womans; a Jewel ſet in white to make it ſeem more white, for the ſkar in a man is a mark of honour and no blemiſh, for 'tis a ſkar and a blemiſh too in a Souldier too to be with out one: Now as for al things elſe which are to procure Love, as a good face, wit, good clothes, or a good body, each of them I confeſs may work ſomewhat for want of a better, That is, if *Valour be not their Rivall*; A good face avails nothing if it be in a coward that is baſhfull, the utmoſt of it is to be kill'd, which rather encreaſeth then quencheth appetite; He that ſends her gifts ſends her word alſo, that he is a man of ſmall gifts otherwiſe, for wooing by ſigns and tokens implies the Author dumb; and if *Ovid* who writ *the Law of Love*, were alive (as he is extant) would allow it as good a ⁷⁹~~diverſity~~verſity, that gifts ſhould be ſent as gratuities, not as bribes; Wit getteth rather promiſe then Love, Wit is not to be ſeen, and no woman takes advice of any in her loving, but of her own eyes, and her waiting womans; Nay which is worſe, wit is not to be felt, and ſo no good fellow; Wit apply'd to a woman makes her diſſolve (or diſcloſe) her ſimpering, and diſcover her teeth with laughter, and this is ſurely a purge for love; for the beginning of love is a kind of fooliſh melancholy, as for the man that makes his Taylor his Bawd, and hopes to inveagle his Love with ſuch a coloured ſuit, ſurely the ſame deeply hazards the loſs of her favour upon every change of his clothes; So likewiſe for the other, that Courts her ſilently with a good body, let me certifie him that his clothes depend upon the comelyneſſe of the body, and ſo both upon opinion; ſhe that hath been ſeduced by Apparel, let me give her to wit, *that men always put off their clothes before they go to bed*; and let her that hath been enamour'd of her ſervants body, underſtand, *that if ſhe ſaw him in a ſkin of cloth*, that is, in a ſuit made to the pattern of his body, *ſhe would ſee ſlender cauſe to love him ever after*; there are no clothes fit ſo well in a woman's eye, ⁸⁰~~as~~a ſuit of Steel, though not of the faſhion, and no man ſo ſoon ſurpriſeth a womans affections as he that is the ſubject of

all whisperings, and hath always twenty stories of his own deeds depending upon him; Mistake me not, I understand not by valour one that never fights but when he is back'd by drink or anger, or hiss'd on with beholders, nor one that is desperate, nor one that takes away a Servingmans weapons when perchance it cost him his quarters wages, nor yet one that wears a Privy coat of defence and therein is confident, for then such as made Bucklers, would be accounted the *Catalines* of this Commonwealth—I intend one of an even Resolution grounded upon reason, which is always even, having his power restrained by the Law of not doing wrong. But now I remember I am for Valour and therefore I must be a man of few words.

Transcriber's Note

Inconsistent period spelling retained as printed. The original printing used *ß* occasionally, but inconsistently, in place of *ff*: this usage has not been retained.

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